

Findings:

Time: 2025-07-13 11:50:03 UTC
IOC Domain: libero[.]it
IOC Domain: duolingo-team[.]com
IOC IP: 5.9.230.8
IOC IP: 90.160.50.35
Subject: Join Us in Creating Unique Material
Sender: duolingo.ads@libero[.]it
Reply to: info@duolingo-team[.]com

Investigation:

On 2025-07-13 11:50:03 UTC, an email was received from duolingo.ads@libero.it, which passed SPF and DKIM checks and was not marked as spam.

The domain libero.it belongs to a freemail provider. The Reply-To email address (duolingo-team.com) does not match the Return-Path address (duolingo.ads@libero.it), which is suspicious.

The domain duolingo-team.com (used in the Reply-To address) was registered on 2025-07-10, which is highly suspicious.

Further investigation shows that the email is missing a Date header, which is uncommon for legitimate business emails.

Additionally, the sender used two IP addresses: 5.9.230.8 (reported by some vendors as malicious) and 90.160.50.35, likely to obfuscate their identity.

Analysis of the email content reveals a generic greeting, no recipient name, vague messaging with no clear offer or conditions, and no professional signature or verifiable social media presence. No attachments or malicious payloads were identified.

The observed IOCs inside this email correlate to brand impersonation and phishing attempt.

Recommendations:

1. Perform a 7-day search across your environment for any emails received from the above domains.
2. Check your email server logs to determine whether other users received the same email, using the ID qEJyG6vVc2jVPwQAe4cVtA.
3. Conduct phishing awareness training for employees.
4. If applicable, consider blocking or restricting the identified suspicious domains and IP addresses.
5. Consider reporting the abuse to libero.it.

WHO - duolingo.ads@libero[.]it

WHAT - sent a phishing email from a legitimate freemail provider

WHEN - 2025-07-13 11:50:03 UTC

WHERE - received on srv7.swhc.ca mailing server

WHY - The intent might be phishing and social engineering

HOW - The email was sent from a legitimate mail server, hiding the real IP address of the sender.